

BUSINESS FUNDING DOCUMENT PREP KIT

Get Your Files Lender-Ready Before You Need Money

The Complete System for Organizing Your Business Documents

VERSION: PROFESSIONAL PDF EDITION

Investment: \$27 (Basic Edition)

WHAT'S INSIDE THIS KIT

A comprehensive collection of 9 professional templates and worksheets designed to help you organize every document lenders will ever need. When funding opportunities arise, you'll be ready to move fast and look professional.

Who This Kit Is For:

- Business owners seeking bank loans or SBA financing
- Entrepreneurs applying for business credit lines
- Small business owners preparing for investor meetings
- Any business owner who wants to look organized and serious

What You Get:

- 9 complete templates and worksheets
 - Step-by-step instructions for each document
 - Professional formatting that lenders recognize
 - Folder organization system for digital and physical files
 - Checklists to ensure nothing falls through the cracks
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SECTION 1: QUICK START GUIDE

The 5-Minute Overview

Here's what you need to know to get started immediately:

Step 1: Understand What Lenders Need

Lenders typically require 8 categories of documents. Understanding these categories helps you prepare systematically rather than scrambling at the last minute.

The 8 Categories:

1. **Business Identity** — Documents that prove your business exists and is legitimate
2. **Financial Statements** — Documents that show your numbers and financial health
3. **Bank Documentation** — Documents that prove you have legitimate banking relationships
4. **Debt Records** — Documents that show your existing financial obligations
5. **Revenue Verification** — Documents that prove your business actually makes money
6. **Collateral Documents** — Documents that show your assets and their value
7. **Personal Financials** — Documents required for personal guarantees
8. **Business Plan** — Documents that demonstrate you have a clear strategy

Step 2: Set Up Your Organization System

Create two parallel systems that work together seamlessly:

Physical System:

- A filing cabinet with 12 labeled folders
- Color-coded tabs for quick identification
- Secure storage in a fireproof location

Digital System:

- A folder structure on your computer mirroring the physical system
- Cloud backup for security and accessibility
- Consistent naming conventions for easy searching

Both systems use the same 12-folder structure, detailed in Section 8.

Step 3: Complete Your Templates

Work through each template in this kit following this recommended order:

1. **Funding Document Checklist** — Start here to understand your complete requirements
2. **Bank Statement Prep Sheet** — Learn how to organize and present your statements
3. **Business Summary Template** — Create your professional one-page overview
4. **Use of Funds Worksheet** — Define exactly how you'll use your funding
5. **Revenue Snapshot Sheet** — Present your financial history professionally
6. **Debt Overview Worksheet** — Document every financial obligation you have
7. **Folder Organization Guide** — Set up your organizational system
8. **Application Readiness Checklist** — Verify everything before submission

Step 4: Maintain Your System

Update your documents quarterly so they're always current. When a funding opportunity arises, you can assemble your complete package in minutes, not hours.

The Payoff:

With this system in place, you'll never scramble for documents again. When the right funding opportunity appears, you'll be the borrower who looks professional, prepared, and serious about success.

SECTION 2: FUNDING DOCUMENT CHECKLIST

Your Complete Guide to Every Document Lenders Will Need

Why This Checklist Matters

Most business owners scramble for documents at the last minute, looking disorganized and unpolished to lenders. This checklist ensures you have everything ready before you need it so you approach funding opportunities with confidence and professionalism.

Lenders make decisions quickly. When your documents are organized and complete, you stand out from the crowd of unprepared applicants. This systematic approach transforms you from a frantic borrower into a professional business owner who commands respect.

The 10 Most Requested Documents

Lenders most frequently request these documents, in order of frequency:

1. **Business Tax Returns (2-3 years)**
 - Verifies your reported income with official government records
 - Shows consistency in your financial reporting
 - Demonstrates legitimate business operations

2. Personal Tax Returns (2-3 years)

- Shows your overall financial picture
- Required for personal guarantee requirements
- Demonstrates your commitment to the business

3. Profit & Loss Statement (last 12 months)

- Demonstrates income, expenses, and net profit trends
- Shows the financial performance of your business
- Reveals patterns and seasonality in your operations

4. Balance Sheet (current)

- Displays your assets, liabilities, and equity at a point in time
- Shows the complete financial position of your business
- Demonstrates your net worth as a business owner

5. Business Bank Statements (last 6-12 months)

- Shows cash flow patterns and account management
- Proves the legitimacy of your banking relationships
- Demonstrates your ability to manage cash effectively

6. Debt Schedule (all current obligations)

- Lists every debt with balances, payments, and terms
- Shows your existing financial obligations
- Helps lenders calculate your debt service capacity

7. Accounts Receivable Aging

- Shows money owed to you by customers with payment status
- Demonstrates the quality of your receivables
- Reveals your cash collection effectiveness

8. Accounts Payable Aging

- Shows money you owe to vendors and suppliers
- Demonstrates your payment practices
- Reveals your relationships with suppliers

9. Business Plan with Use of Funds

- Demonstrates strategy and clear thinking
- Explains exactly how you'll use the financing
- Shows lenders you've thought through your plans carefully

10. Personal Financial Statement

- Summarizes personal assets and liabilities for guarantee requirements
 - Shows the overall financial strength of the business owner
 - Demonstrates your commitment and skin in the game
-

Complete Document Categories

Category 1: Business Identity Documents

These establish your business as a legitimate entity and are the foundation of your application.

Document	Why Lenders Need It	Status
Articles of Incorporation	Proves your business exists legally and is properly registered	☐
Business License	Shows you're authorized to operate in your jurisdiction	☐
EIN Confirmation Letter	Identifies your business for tax purposes and banking	☐
DBA (Doing Business As) Filings	Confirms any alternate business names you're using	☐
Operating Agreement or Bylaws	Demonstrates your governance structure and ownership	☐

Action Required: Make copies of all identity documents and store them in your "Business Basics" folder. Ensure they're current and not expired.

Category 2: Financial Statements

These show the numbers behind your business and demonstrate your financial performance.

Document	Time Period	Why Lenders Need It	Status
Profit & Loss Statement	Last 12 months	Shows income, expenses, and net profit	☐
Balance Sheet	Current	Displays assets, liabilities, and equity	☐
Cash Flow Statement	Last 12 months	Demonstrates how money moves through your business	☐
Income Tax Returns	2-3 years	Verifies reported income with official records	☐
Accounts Payable Aging Report	Current	Shows money you owe to vendors	☐
Accounts Receivable Aging Report	Current	Shows money owed to you by customers	☐

Action Required: Prepare your last 12 months of P&L statements and your most recent balance sheet. Update these quarterly so they're always ready.

Category 3: Bank Documentation

These prove your business has legitimate banking relationships and demonstrate cash management skills.

Document	Time Period	Why Lenders Need It	Status
Business Bank Statements	Last 12 months	Shows your cash flow patterns and account health	☐
Business Checking Confirmation	Current	Verifies your primary business account	☐
Savings/Money Market Statements	Last 6 months	Shows reserves and financial stability	☐
Merchant Services Statements	Last 3 months	Demonstrates card processing revenue	☐

Action Required: Request official copies from your bank or download from online banking. See Section 3 for tips on presenting these effectively.

Category 4: Debt Documentation

These show your existing financial obligations and help lenders calculate your debt service capacity.

Document	Current Balance	Monthly Payment	Status
Loan Statements (all current)		☐	
Credit Card Statements (business)		☐	
Lines of Credit Statements		☐	
Vendor Financing Agreements		☐	
Leasing Agreements		☐	

Action Required: List every debt with current balance, interest rate, and monthly payment. Use the Debt Overview Worksheet in Section 7 to organize this information.

Category 5: Revenue Verification

These prove your business actually makes money and help lenders assess your income stability.

Document	Time Period	Why Lenders Need It	Status
Sales/Invoice Records	Last 12 months	Shows your revenue volume and patterns	☐
Contracts with Major Customers	Current	Demonstrates recurring revenue stability	☐
Point-of-Sale Reports	Last 3 months	Verifies cash-based revenue	☐
Payment Processor Records	Last 3 months	Shows online transaction volume	☐

Action Required: Pull your last 12 months of sales data and organize by month. Use the Revenue Snapshot Sheet in Section 6 to format this data for lenders.

Category 6: Collateral Documentation

These support secured loan applications and help lenders understand your asset base.

Asset Type	Original Value	Current Value	Pledged?
Real Estate		☐	
Equipment		☐	
Vehicles		☐	
Inventory		☐	
Investments		☐	

Action Required: List all business assets with estimated current value. Note which ones are already pledged as collateral on existing loans.

Category 7: Personal Financial Documents

Lenders often require personal guarantees from business owners, making these documents essential.

Document	Time Period	Why Lenders Need It	Status
Personal Tax Returns	2-3 years	Shows your overall financial picture	☐
Personal Bank Statements	Last 3 months	Shows personal cash flow	☐
Personal Balance Sheet	Current	Summarizes your personal assets and liabilities	☐

Document	Time Period	Why Lenders Need It	Status
Real Estate Holdings Documentation	Current	Shows property equity you could leverage	☐

Action Required: Gather your personal financial documents separately and store them in a "Personal Finance" folder. You'll need these alongside your business documents for most applications.

Category 8: Business Plan & Strategy Documents

These show lenders you have a clear plan and understand your market.

Document	Last Updated	Why Lenders Need It	Status
Executive Summary		Shows you have thought through your business	☐
Use of Funds Description		Explains exactly how you'll use the financing	☐
Cash Flow Projections (12 months)		Demonstrates ability to repay the loan	☐
Market Analysis		Shows you understand your industry	☐

Action Required: Complete the Use of Funds Worksheet in Section 5 to clearly articulate your funding goals and strategy.

Document Organization Tips

Digital Organization:

- Create a master folder structure (see Section 8)
- Use consistent naming conventions: `[Document_Type]_[Date]_[Version].pdf`
- Store in cloud backup (Google Drive, Dropbox, etc.)
- Update documents quarterly before you need them

Physical Organization:

- Maintain matching physical folder system
- Use color-coded tabs for quick identification
- Keep in fireproof safe or secure location
- Update when new versions are created

The Key Principle:

Consistency is everything. Use the same folder names, same structure, and same naming conventions everywhere. When everything has a predictable place, you'll never waste time searching.

SECTION 3: BANK STATEMENT PREP SHEET

How to Organize and Present Your Business Bank Statements

Understanding What Lenders Look For

When a lender reviews your bank statements, they're evaluating five key factors that reveal the true health of your business:

1. Average Daily Balance

This is the average amount of money in your account over the statement period. Lenders calculate this by adding up each day's balance and dividing by the number of days.

What they're looking for: Higher average balances suggest financial stability. They want to see balances that would cover your proposed monthly loan payment multiple times over.

Pro tip: Review your last 12 months of statements and note any months where the average balance dropped significantly. Be prepared to explain these periods with context about what happened and how you resolved it.

2. Cash Flow Consistency

Lenders analyze the patterns in your deposits. Consistent, regular deposits from customers suggest reliable revenue. Highly variable deposits raise concerns about income stability.

What they're looking for: Predictable deposit patterns that match your described business model. If you invoice clients and they pay on net-30 terms, lenders expect that pattern.

Pro tip: Create a deposit pattern analysis showing lenders what "normal" looks like for your business. This helps them understand your cash flow cycle and feel confident in your consistency.

3. Expense Management

Lenders look at how you manage expenses. Large, unusual withdrawals or consistent overspending can signal poor financial management.

What they're looking for: Expenses that align with your business type and size. Regular, reasonable payments to vendors and suppliers.

Pro tip: Categorize your major expenses on a separate sheet. When you can explain where money goes, you look more competent and organized.

4. Balance Trends

The overall direction of your balances matters. Growing balances suggest a healthy, profitable business. Declining balances raise concerns.

What they're looking for: Either stable balances with sufficient reserves OR growing balances demonstrating business growth.

Pro tip: Calculate your month-over-month balance change. If you've grown by \$5,000 over the year, highlight this. Lenders love to see businesses that are trending upward.

5. Red Flags

Lenders train themselves to spot warning signs. Overdrafts, large unexplained transfers, or suspicious activity can kill your application.

What to watch for: Multiple overdrafts, large transfers to unknown parties, consistent low balances, or irregular deposit patterns.

Pro tip: If you see red flags in your history, address them proactively. Explain what happened and what you changed. Transparency builds trust.

Step-by-Step Preparation Process

Step 1: Gather Your Statements

Collect the last 12 months of business bank statements. If applying for a smaller loan, 6 months may suffice, but 12 months provides the most comprehensive picture and demonstrates consistency over time.

Where to get them:

- Download from your online banking portal (preferred method)
- Request official copies from your bank branch
- Access through your bank's mobile app
- Use your bank's customer service line

Format considerations:

- PDF format is preferred for digital applications
- Official bank copies with the bank's logo and letterhead are best
- Avoid screenshots—lenders want authentic documentation
- Ensure all pages are included (statements often span multiple pages)

Step 2: Review Each Statement

Before presenting your statements, review them critically. Look for:

Deposits to highlight:

- Regular customer payments
- Recurring revenue streams
- Large contracts or one-time payments
- Transfers from savings (shows reserves and financial discipline)

Items to explain:

- Large irregular withdrawals
- Transfers to personal accounts
- Large payments to vendors
- Any deposits that might look unusual without context

Create a brief note for each statement explaining any items that might raise questions. Transparency builds trust, and lenders appreciate business owners who anticipate concerns.

Step 3: Organize by Date Range

Structure your statement package chronologically, most recent first. Each statement should be complete and include all pages.

Recommended file naming:

```
2026_04_Bank_Statement.pdf
2026_03_Bank_Statement.pdf
...
2025_05_Bank_Statement.pdf
```

Use consistent naming conventions that include the month and year. This makes it easy for you and for lenders to reference specific periods.

Step 4: Create a Summary Page

Add a one-page summary that lenders can review quickly. This should include:

Account Overview:

- Bank name and account number (last 4 digits only for security)
- Account type (checking, savings, money market)
- Average monthly balance
- Highest balance in the period
- Lowest balance in the period
- Total deposits over the period
- Total withdrawals over the period

Monthly Summary:

Month	Ending Balance	Total Deposits	Total Withdrawals
Jan		\$	
Feb		\$	

Month	Ending Balance	Total Deposits	Total Withdrawals
Mar		\$	
Apr		\$	
May		\$	
Jun		\$	
Jul		\$	
Aug		\$	
Sep		\$	
Oct		\$	
Nov		\$	
Dec		\$	
Average	** **	\$	

Step 5: Highlight Positive Patterns

When your bank statements show healthy patterns, make them obvious. Create a separate highlights page that calls attention to:

Positive Trend #1: Growing Balances

"Over the past 12 months, our average monthly balance has grown from 15,000 to 28,000, demonstrating consistent business growth and improved cash management."

Positive Trend #2: Stable Revenue

"Monthly deposits average \$22,000 with consistent patterns, indicating stable customer payment behavior and reliable revenue streams."

Positive Trend #3: Cash Reserves

"Our lowest balance this year was \$18,500, well above our operating expenses, demonstrating healthy cash reserves and financial stability."

Common Issues and How to Handle Them

Issue: Large Irregular Deposits

Problem: A \$50,000 deposit that doesn't match your normal pattern might look suspicious to lenders.

Solution: Add a note explaining the deposit. "Deposit represents payment from ABC Corp for project completion, as outlined in contract dated March 15, 2026."

Issue: Transfers to Personal Accounts

Problem: Regular transfers to personal accounts can raise questions about how you compensate yourself and whether you're taking excessive draws.

Solution: Be prepared to explain your compensation structure. Business owners who take regular draws are common—just be ready to show that draws are reasonable, consistent, and documented.

Issue: Low Balance Periods

Problem: Your business had a slow month with low balances that might concern lenders.

Solution: Context matters. If you know why (seasonal slowdown, large equipment purchase, tax payment, inventory build), explain it clearly. Lenders understand that businesses have fluctuations. Show them you understand your business cycle.

Issue: Overdrafts

Problem: Your statements show one or more overdrafts, which raise red flags about cash management.

Solution: These are concerning to lenders, but not necessarily disqualifying. Be ready to explain what happened and how you fixed the underlying issue. If it was a one-time event with clear causes and you've since improved your processes, you can often overcome this concern.

Best Practices for Bank Statement Presentation

Do This:

- Present complete statements: Include all pages, not just the summary page
- Use official documents: Download directly from your bank
- Organize chronologically: Most recent first
- Add context: Include a summary page and explanatory notes
- Highlight positives: Draw attention to healthy patterns and trends
- Be transparent: Explain anything that might look unusual
- Keep copies: Store both digital and physical backups

Avoid This:

- Don't use altered statements: Never edit bank statements
 - Don't hide negative items: Address issues directly and proactively
 - Don't skip months: Gaps in statements raise red flags
 - Don't use illegible copies: Ensure all numbers are clear and readable
 - Don't include personal statements: Only show business accounts
-

SECTION 4: BUSINESS SUMMARY TEMPLATE

A Professional One-Page Overview That Lenders Love

Purpose of This Document

This business summary gives lenders a quick, comprehensive overview of your company. It should be concise enough to read in two minutes but informative enough to answer their most important questions.

A strong business summary demonstrates that you understand your business and can communicate clearly—qualities that lenders value highly. They see hundreds of applications; a polished, professional summary makes you stand out.

Template Structure

Copy the structure below and fill in your specific information. Replace all bracketed text with your actual business data.

[YOUR COMPANY NAME]

Business Summary

Date Prepared: [Month/Year]

Prepared By: [Your Name], [Your Title]

Company Overview

Field	Your Information
Legal Business Name	
DBA (if different)	
Business Address	
Phone	
Email	
Website	
Years in Operation	

Field	Your Information
Legal Structure	LLC / Corporation / Partnership / Sole Prop
Industry	
Number of Employees	

Business Description

What does your business do?

[Write 2-3 sentences describing your core business. What products or services do you offer? What problem do you solve for your customers? Describe what makes your offering valuable.]

Who are your customers?

[Describe your target market. What are their characteristics? Where are they located? What do they need that you provide? Be specific about your ideal customer profile.]

What makes you different?

[Explain your competitive advantage. Why do customers choose you over competitors? What unique value do you offer? What is your secret sauce?]

Leadership & Experience

Role	Name	Experience Summary	Years in Industry
Owner/CEO			
Operations			
Finance			
Sales			

Combined Leadership Experience: _____ years

Products or Services

Product/Service	Description	% of Revenue	Trend
		%	
		%	

Product/Service	Description	% of Revenue	Trend
		%	
		%	

Primary Revenue Driver: _____

Financial Performance

Metric	Your Number	vs. Prior Year
Annual Revenue	\$	+-%
Monthly Average Revenue	\$	+-%
Gross Profit Margin	%	+ pts
Net Profit Margin	%	+ pts
Year-over-Year Growth	%	

Revenue Trend: ☐ Increasing ☐ Stable ☐ Seasonal

Customer Base

Metric	Your Number
Total Active Customers	
Average Customer Value	\$
Repeat Customer Rate	%
Largest Customer (% of revenue)	%
Top 5 Customers (% of revenue)	%

Customer Concentration Note: _____

Competitive Advantages

Key Strength #1: _____

Key Strength #2: _____

Key Strength #3: _____

Funding Request Summary

Item	Your Request
Funding Amount Requested	\$
Purpose	
Requested Term	months
Expected Impact	

How this funding will help your business:

SECTION 5: USE OF FUNDS WORKSHEET

Clearly Explain How You'll Use Your Funding

Why This Matters

Lenders don't just want to know that you need money—they want to understand exactly how you'll use it and how the investment will generate returns. A vague answer like "working capital" signals uncertainty and lack of planning. A detailed use-of-funds plan demonstrates strategic thinking and gives lenders confidence in your ability to manage their money responsibly.

This worksheet guides you through creating a complete, compelling explanation of your funding request that shows lenders you've thought carefully about every dollar.

Section 1: Funding Request Overview

Total Funding Amount Requested: \$ _____

Type of Financing:

- ☐ Term Loan
- ☐ Line of Credit
- ☐ SBA Loan
- ☐ Equipment Financing
- ☐ Commercial Mortgage
- ☐ Business Credit Card
- ☐ Other: _____

Purpose Classification:

- ☐ Growth/Expansion
- ☐ Working Capital
- ☐ Equipment Purchase
- ☐ Real Estate
- ☐ Debt Refinancing
- ☐ Inventory
- ☐ Marketing/Sales
- ☐ Technology/Software
- ☐ Other: _____

Requested Loan Term: _____ months

Section 2: Detailed Use of Funds Breakdown

List every category where funding will be allocated. Be specific—lenders appreciate detailed plans that show you've thought through every use of their money.

Category	Description	Amount	% of Total	Deployment Date
Primary Use		\$	%	
Secondary Use		\$	%	
Tertiary Use		\$	%	
Reserve		\$	%	
TOTAL		\$	100%	

Example:

Category	Description	Amount	% of Total	Deployment Date
Primary Use	New equipment purchase	\$40,000	67%	Month 1
Secondary Use	Hire two new employees	\$15,000	25%	Month 2-3
Reserve	Working capital buffer	\$5,000	8%	Month 1
TOTAL		\$60,000	100%	

Section 3: Expected Return on Investment

For each major use of funds, document expected financial impact:

Use #1: _____

Return Type	Value	Timeframe
Increased Revenue	\$ / month	
Cost Reduction	\$ / month	
New Customers Acquired		
Efficiency Gain	%	

Return on Investment: _____%

Break-even Timeline: _____ months

Use #2: _____

Return Type	Value	Timeframe
Increased Revenue	\$ / month	
Cost Reduction	\$ / month	
New Customers Acquired		
Efficiency Gain	%	

Return on Investment: _____%

Break-even Timeline: _____ months

Section 4: Repayment Strategy

Primary Repayment Source: _____

Projected Monthly Cash Flow After New Payment:

Item	Amount
Average Monthly Revenue	\$
Average Monthly Expenses	\$
Existing Debt Payments	\$
New Loan Payment	\$
Net Monthly Cash Flow	\$

Debt Service Coverage Ratio: _____

Target: 1.25 or higher for most lenders

Full Repayment Timeline: _____ months

Section 5: Risk Assessment

What could go wrong?

Risk	Financial Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Revenue lower than projected	\$	
Costs higher than projected	\$	
Key customer loss	% of revenue	

Worst-Case Scenario: If revenue drops by __%, could still make payments with: \$ _____

SECTION 6: REVENUE SNAPSHOT SHEET

Present Your Business Revenue Professionally

Why This Matters

Lenders need to understand your revenue history to assess your ability to repay a loan. This Revenue Snapshot Sheet formats your financial data into a clear, professional presentation that makes your business's financial health immediately apparent. A well-organized revenue snapshot builds confidence and speeds the approval process. Lenders can quickly verify your claims and assess your business's stability.

Annual Revenue Overview

Year	Total Revenue	vs. Prior Year	Key Events
2023	\$	—	[Any significant events]
2024	\$	+-%	[Any significant events]
2025	\$	+-%	[Any significant events]

3-Year Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR): _____ %

Monthly Revenue Breakdown (Trailing 12 Months)

Month	Revenue	vs. Prior Month	vs. Same Month Last Year	Notes
Jan	\$	%	%	
Feb	\$	%	%	
Mar	\$	%	%	
Apr	\$	%	%	
May	\$	%	%	
Jun	\$	%	%	
Jul	\$	%	%	
Aug	\$	%	%	
Sep	\$	%	%	
Oct	\$	%	%	
Nov	\$	%	%	
Dec	\$	%	%	
Total	\$			

Revenue by Product/Service Line

Product/Service	Annual Revenue	% of Total	Transactions	Avg Value	Trend

Key Revenue Metrics Summary

Metric	Your Number
Trailing 12-Month Revenue	\$
Average Monthly Revenue	\$

Metric	Your Number
Year-over-Year Growth	%
Largest Month Revenue	\$
Smallest Month Revenue	\$
Gross Profit Margin	%

Customer Concentration

Customer	Annual Revenue	% of Total	Relationship Length
Largest	\$	%	years
2nd Largest	\$	%	years
3rd Largest	\$	%	years
Top 5 Total	\$	%	
Top 10 Total	\$	%	

Diversification Note: _____

SECTION 7: DEBT OVERVIEW WORKSHEET

Document Every Dollar You Owe

Why This Matters

Lenders need to understand your complete debt obligations before extending new credit. They calculate your debt service coverage ratio, evaluate your leverage, and assess risk based on your existing obligations.

A comprehensive debt overview demonstrates financial transparency and shows lenders you manage your obligations responsibly. It's better to disclose everything upfront than to have lenders discover hidden debts.

Complete Debt Inventory

Secured Debt:

Debt Name	Lender	Account# (last 4)	Current Balance	Monthly Payment	Interest Rate	Collateral
				%		
				%		
				%		

Unsecured Debt:

Debt Name	Lender	Credit Limit	Current Balance	Monthly Payment	Interest Rate
			\$	%	
			\$	%	
			\$	%	

Lines of Credit:

Institution	Credit Limit	Current Balance	Available	Interest Rate
		\$	%	
		\$	%	

Leases:

Type	Lessor	Monthly Payment	Remaining Term	Total Remaining	End Date
		months			

Debt Summary

Debt Type	Count	Total Balance	Monthly Payment	Avg Rate
Secured Loans			%	
Unsecured Loans			%	
Credit Cards			%	
Lines of Credit			%	
Leases			%	

Debt Type	Count	Total Balance	Monthly Payment	Avg Rate
TOTAL		** **	%	

Debt Service Analysis

Monthly Revenue: \$ _____

Total Monthly Debt Service: \$ _____

Debt Service Ratio: _____%

Target: Below 50% for most lenders

Credit Utilization

Card	Limit	Balance	Utilization
		%	
		%	
		%	
TOTAL	** **	%	

Target: Keep overall utilization below 30%

SECTION 8: FOLDER ORGANIZATION GUIDE

Set Up a System That Makes You Look Professional

Why This Matters

When you apply for funding, lenders don't just evaluate your business—they evaluate you. Business owners who can produce documents quickly and accurately demonstrate operational competence. Those who scramble for hours looking for statements appear disorganized and potentially risky.

This guide teaches you how to organize your financial documents so you're always ready. A well-organized system takes one weekend to set up and saves countless hours every time you need to pull documents together.

The Basic Framework

Your document organization system has two components working in parallel:

1. **Physical Files** — Paper documents, printed statements, contracts, and official paperwork
2. **Digital Files** — Electronic copies stored on your computer or cloud storage

Both systems follow the same folder structure, making it easy to find documents whether you're looking at a physical file cabinet or a computer folder.

Key Principle: Consistency is everything. Use the same folder names, same structure, and same naming conventions everywhere. When everything has a predictable place, you'll never waste time searching.

The Master Folder Structure

Create one master folder on your computer named "Business Funding Documents"
Inside that folder, create the following subfolders:

```
Business Funding Documents/  
├─ 01_Business_Identity/  
├─ 02_Financial_Statements/  
├─ 03_Bank_Documents/  
├─ 04_Debt_Documentation/  
├─ 05_Revenue_Records/  
├─ 06_Collateral_Documentation/  
├─ 07_Personal_Financials/  
├─ 08_Business_Plan/  
├─ 09_Tax>Returns/  
├─ 10_Insurance/  
├─ 11_Licenses_Permits/  
└─ 12_Submission_Ready/
```

Folder Descriptions

Folder 01: Business Identity

Store documents that prove your business exists and is legitimate:

- Articles of Incorporation
- Business License
- EIN Confirmation Letter
- Operating Agreement or Bylaws

- DBA Filings
- Business Registration Documents

Naming: `Business_Identity_[Document_Type]_[Date].pdf`

Folder 02: Financial Statements

Store your profit & loss statements, balance sheets, and financial reports:

- Profit & Loss Statements (monthly, quarterly, annual)
- Balance Sheets
- Cash Flow Statements
- Accounts Receivable/Payable Aging Reports
- Financial Ratios Analysis

Naming: `Financials_[Type]_[Period]_[Date].pdf`

Folder 03: Bank Documents

Store all documentation of your banking relationships:

- Business Checking Account Statements (12 months rolling)
- Business Savings Account Statements
- Money Market Account Statements
- Merchant Services Statements
- Bank Correspondence

Naming: `[Bank_Initial]_Account_[Last4]_[YYYY_MM].pdf`

Folder 04: Debt Documentation

Store all records of money your business owes:

- Loan Agreements and Statements
- Credit Card Statements
- Line of Credit Statements
- Lease Agreements
- Vendor Financing Agreements

Naming: `Debt_[Type]_[Lender]_[Last4]_[Date].pdf`

Folder 05: Revenue Records

Store documentation proving how much money your business makes:

- Sales Reports (monthly, annual)
- Invoice Records
- Major Customer Contracts
- Payment Processor Records

Naming: Revenue_[Type]_[Period]_[Date].pdf

Folder 06: Collateral Documentation

Store records of business assets that could be pledged as collateral:

- Equipment Titles and Ownership Documents
- Vehicle Registrations
- Real Estate Deeds and Mortgages
- Inventory Reports
- UCC Filing Documentation

Naming: Collateral_[Type]_[Description]_[Date].pdf

Folder 07: Personal Financials

Store personal financial documents required for personal guarantees:

- Personal Tax Returns (2-3 years)
- Personal Bank Statements (3-6 months)
- Personal Balance Sheet
- Personal Investment Statements

Naming: Personal_[Document_Type]_[Year].pdf

Folder 08: Business Plan

Store your business plan and strategic documents:

- Executive Summary
- Full Business Plan
- Use of Funds Description
- Cash Flow Projections

Naming: Business_Plan_[Document]_[Version]_[Date].pdf

Folder 09: Tax Returns

Store your business tax returns for multiple years:

- Business Tax Returns (3 years minimum)
- Tax Extension Documents
- IRS Correspondence

Naming: Tax_Business_[Year]_[Type]_[Date_Filed].pdf

Folder 10: Insurance

Store all business insurance documentation:

- General Liability Insurance Policy
- Property Insurance Policy

- Workers Compensation Insurance
- Commercial Auto Insurance
- Insurance Certificates

Naming: Insurance_[Type]_[Policy_Number]_[Year].pdf

Folder 11: Licenses and Permits

Store all business licenses, permits, and certifications:

- Business License
- Professional Licenses
- Industry Certifications
- Permits (building, environmental, health, etc.)

Naming: License_[Type]_[Issuing_Authority]_[Expiry_Date].pdf

Folder 12: Submission Ready

Store compiled document packages ready for specific applications:

- Lender-specific compiled packages
- Completed Application Forms
- Submission Checklists
- Follow-up Documentation

Naming: Submission_[Lender]_[Type]_[Date].pdf

Maintenance Schedule

Weekly Tasks (5 minutes):

- Move new digital documents into proper folders
- File physical documents immediately when received
- Update any incomplete file naming

Monthly Tasks (15 minutes):

- Review 03 Bank Documents folder
- Move last month to archive subfolder
- Add any new statements to 02 Financial Statements

Quarterly Tasks (30 minutes):

- Update financial statement folders
- Verify all documents are current
- Review folder structure for needed additions

Annual Tasks (1 hour):

- Archive old documents (move to yearly archive folders)

- Clean up and delete unnecessary files
 - Review and update folder structure if needed
 - Update tax return folders with new year
-

SECTION 9: APPLICATION READINESS CHECKLIST

The Final Step Before Submitting Any Funding Application

Why This Matters

You've gathered your documents, organized your files, and prepared your business summary. Before you submit your application, run through this checklist to ensure nothing falls through the cracks. A single missing document or simple error can delay your application by weeks—or result in denial.

Use this checklist for every funding application, whether it's your first or your tenth.

Document Completeness Check

Business Identity:

- ☐ Articles of Incorporation (current, complete)
- ☐ Business License (current, not expired)
- ☐ EIN Confirmation Letter
- ☐ Operating Agreement/Bylaws

Financial Documents:

- ☐ P&L Statements (12 months, complete)
- ☐ Balance Sheet (current, within 90 days)
- ☐ Cash Flow Statement (last 12 months)
- ☐ Accounts Receivable Aging (current)
- ☐ Accounts Payable Aging (current)

Bank Statements:

- ☐ Business Checking Statements (12 months, all pages)
- ☐ Business Savings Statements (if applicable)
- ☐ Merchant Services Statements (last 3 months)

Tax Returns:

- ☐ Business Tax Returns (2-3 years, filed)
- ☐ Personal Tax Returns (2-3 years, filed)

Debt Documentation:

- ☐ All Loan Statements (current balances)
- ☐ Credit Card Statements (last 3 months)
- ☐ Line of Credit Statements
- ☐ Lease Agreements

Personal Financials:

- ☐ Personal Tax Returns (2-3 years)
- ☐ Personal Bank Statements (3-6 months)
- ☐ Personal Balance Sheet

Business Plan:

- ☐ Business Summary
 - ☐ Use of Funds Description
 - ☐ Cash Flow Projections
-

Financial Consistency Verification

Verify that figures are consistent across all documents:

Revenue Consistency:

- P&L Annual Revenue: \$ _____
- Tax Return Revenue: \$ _____
- Bank Statement Deposits: \$ _____

Status: ☐ Consistent ☐ Discrepancy Found

If discrepancy found: Document explanation and attach to application.

Debt Consistency:

- Balance Sheet Liabilities: \$ _____
- Debt Schedule Total: \$ _____

Status: ☐ Consistent ☐ Discrepancy Found

If discrepancy found: Document explanation and attach to application.

Time Period Consistency:

- Financial statements cover: [Date] to [Date]
- Bank statements cover: [Date] to [Date]
- Tax returns are for years: [Year], [Year], [Year]

Status: ☐ Consistent ☐ Discrepancy Found

Final Quality Review

Completeness Check:

- ☐ All required documents are present
- ☐ No placeholder text or "TBD" in final submission
- ☐ All explanations are complete and thorough
- ☐ All required signatures are present
- ☐ All dates are accurate and current

Professional Appearance:

- ☐ Documents are clean and professional
- ☐ No handwritten changes on official documents
- ☐ Consistent formatting throughout
- ☐ Documents are properly organized

Accuracy Double-Check:

- ☐ Proofread all written explanations
 - ☐ Verified all calculations
 - ☐ Confirmed all dates
 - ☐ Cross-checked all names and numbers
 - ☐ Business name is consistent across all documents
 - ☐ EIN matches all documents
-

Submission Confirmation

Submission Date: _____

Submitted To: _____

Confirmation Number: _____

Follow-Up Date: _____

SECTION 10: NEXT STEPS & RESOURCES

Your Path to Funding Success

1. Complete Your Templates

Work through each template in this kit following the recommended order:

1. Funding Document Checklist — Know what you need to gather
2. Bank Statement Prep Sheet — Organize your statements professionally

3. Business Summary Template — Create your lender-ready overview
 4. Use of Funds Worksheet — Define exactly how you'll use the funding
 5. Revenue Snapshot Sheet — Present your financial history clearly
 6. Debt Overview Worksheet — Document every financial obligation
 7. Folder Organization Guide — Set up your organizational system
 8. Application Readiness Checklist — Verify everything before submission
-

2. Maintain Your System

Weekly Tasks (5 minutes):

- Move new digital documents into proper folders
- File physical documents immediately when received
- Update any incomplete file naming

Monthly Tasks (15 minutes):

- Review 03 Bank Documents folder
- Move last month to archive subfolder
- Add any new statements to 02 Financial Statements

Quarterly Tasks (30 minutes):

- Update financial statement folders with latest data
 - Verify all documents are current
 - Review folder structure for needed additions
-

3. When Funding Opportunities Arise

When you need to apply for funding:

1. Pull your Application Readiness Checklist
2. Update all documents to current dates
3. Verify consistency across all documents
4. Assemble lender-specific package in 12_Submission_Ready folder
5. Submit with confidence

Expected Time to Assemble Complete Package: 15-30 minutes

Common Mistakes to Avoid

Mistake 1: Submitting outdated documents

Lenders want statements from the last 30-90 days, not from six months ago. Update your documents regularly so they're always ready.

Mistake 2: Missing pages

Bank statements often span multiple pages. Ensure every page is included in your submission package.

Mistake 3: Inconsistent business names

Your legal name, DBA, and bank account name must align across all documents—or be clearly explained. Inconsistencies raise red flags.

Mistake 4: Forgetting personal guarantees

If you personally guarantee the loan, include your personal financial documents. Many applications fail because owners forget this critical piece.

Mistake 5: Unclear use of funds

"Lump sum" and "working capital" are vague. Be specific about exactly what the money will accomplish and how it will generate returns.

Mistake 6: Math errors

Double-check every calculation. Lenders will catch mistakes, and they raise questions about your attention to detail.

Pro Tips for Successful Applications

1. **Submit complete packages** — Partial applications get delayed or denied. Include everything.
 2. **Tell a coherent story** — Your documents should tell the same story. Consistency builds credibility.
 3. **Be proactive** — If something looks unusual, explain it before they ask. Anticipate concerns.
 4. **Follow instructions** — Lenders often have specific formatting requirements. Follow them exactly.
 5. **Stay organized** — Keep copies of everything you submit. Document your submission.
 6. **Follow up** — Call to confirm receipt and check on status. Professional persistence is appreciated.
 7. **Be responsive** — Answer lender questions quickly to keep the process moving.
-

ABOUT THIS KIT

Business Funding Document Prep Kit — Basic Edition

\$27 One-Time Payment

This comprehensive kit includes:

- 9 professional templates and worksheets
- Folder organization system for digital and physical files
- Step-by-step instructions for each document

- Checklists to ensure nothing falls through the cracks
- Professional formatting designed for lenders

Perfect for:

- Business owners seeking bank loans or SBA financing
 - Entrepreneurs applying for business credit lines
 - Small business owners preparing for investor meetings
 - Any business owner who wants to look organized and serious
-

UPGRADE TO PROFESSIONAL EDITION

Want more? Upgrade to Professional Edition for \$127 and get:

- **Editable Word versions** of all templates
- **Fillable PDF forms** for easy digital completion
- **Advanced lender prep worksheets** with detailed guidance
- **Email scripts** for following up with lenders professionally
- **Financial ratio calculator** with benchmarking
- **Cash flow projection template** for lender presentations
- **Lender meeting preparation guide** with conversation starters
- **Priority support access** for questions
- **Lifetime updates** included

Visit your order link to upgrade today.

This document is for informational purposes only. Consult with financial and legal professionals for specific advice regarding your business funding needs.

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